

Indian domain registrar and Web hosting hero, the sad fact is we are yet to find one.

1.2.2 Dedicated Server / Co-location server

Dedicated servers give you exclusive use of a single server machine to host your Web site. While they are more expensive, dedicated servers might make more sense if you are hosting sensitive data and/or have high volume traffic. Since there are no other Web sites on your machine, you can make full use of the entire resources of the server without fear of suffering from performance issues. Of course, beyond a certain load you would need to upgrade your server to ensure consistency in performance.

A dedicated server, in effect, is rented out from the hosting provider. When shopping around for one, make sure its specifications are suited to your Web site's requirements. Some hosts only provide a barebones machine with just the operating system (usually Windows or Linux). You would need to procure and install all the software and databases. Many have bundled offers where they provide a default set of software that can be hacked to suit your requirements. They would include: chat, bulletin boards and shopping card software, support for VoIP applications, support for Flash, and so forth.

A co-located server on the other hand is one that you own and which is placed in the data centre premises of the hosting provider. You can load any and all software that you require, and the host's responsibility is to ensure that your server remains constantly powered on while providing you with the agreed-upon bandwidth.

Dedicated server pricing can vary widely, and depends on the server configuration, the level of technical support and other factors, which differ from host to host.

1.2.3 How to choose a Web host

Choosing a Web host is one of the most important decisions you will make. Generally, the hosting provider should be able to give